

LANESKIFF · PRECIS

LaneSkiff design precis

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/laneskiff		
Source	docs/02-concept.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.3	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Amish's decisions 30A, 31C and 32A (LSK-DDR-003): light timber specification, five-person rating, bottom 60 mm wider, stern quarter foam and the aft-crew rule, no fin drive in the first prototype; numbers from LSK-CAL-001 v0.2
0.2	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Concept formulated (TRL 2) and made constructable (TRL 3); components with BOM numbers, key design choices, first-order numbers, material table, safety
0.1	2026-09-30	Amish Chadha	Initial scaffold

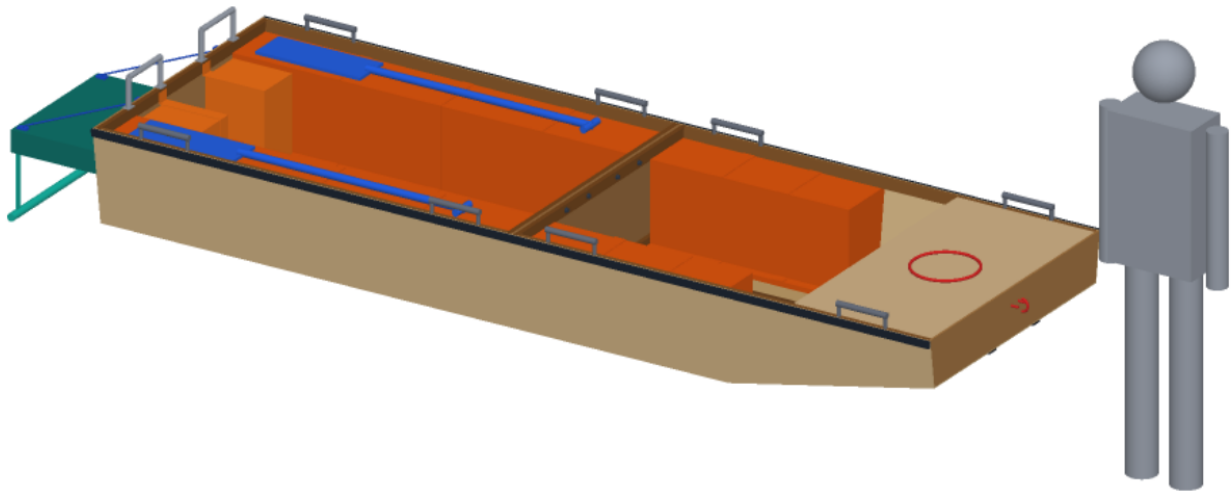
LaneSkiff design precis

A flat-bottomed flood rescue boat two people carry into flooded lanes, with a floating stern step so people can climb in from waist-deep water.

LaneSkiff

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/laneskiff

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION



Seen from the front right and above, 24 deg elevation. Grey figure: 1.75 m person for scale

Figure 1. LaneSkiff assembled, stern step deployed, with a 1.75 m person for scale. CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION.

■ How it works

LaneSkiff is a punt-form skiff 3.6 m long and 1.197 m wide over its rub strakes, 0.40 m deep, built in two rigid halves of 1.8 m. Each half is a closed okoume plywood box with its own end panel and its own joint bulkhead, so each half floats on its own and the joint between them carries load but needs no seal. Eight M10 bolts join the halves through softwood ring frames on the two bulkheads; one spanner does it, because the nuts are welded to plates on the aft frame.

The bottom is flat for 2.7 m and rakes up to 200 mm at the bow, so the boat rides over kerbs and debris and can be poled in shallow water. The sides are flat plywood panels leaning out 8 degrees, which gives a wide waterline for stability and a narrow enough beam for lanes.

Buoyancy follows the LevelHull layout: closed-cell foam modules run along both sides under the inwales, and a foam-filled bow box sits under a short bow deck. Two 15 L foam modules stand in the stern quarters, either side of the step opening. When the boat is swamped, the foam is outboard and high enough that the boat floats nearly level with its rated persons aboard, and the aft crew member moves amidships.

At the stern centre, a buoyant step float lies on the water behind the transom, hinged to a hardwood rail. A kick rung hangs 270 mm below it on webbing. A person in waist-deep water puts a foot on the rung, takes the two transom grab handles, kneels on the float and rolls over the transom. Boarding over the end of the boat heels it about 3 degrees, against about 13 degrees for the same person climbing over the side. Stop straps hold the float at 20 degrees below level, and a 40 mm gap between float and rail keeps fingers and feet clear through its whole swing.

The crew poles the boat with a two-section push pole or paddles it. Eight carry handles, two at each end of each half, and two padded shoulder slings let people carry each half into a lane and join the halves at the water.

■ Components

Table 1. Components (BOM line numbers from `bom/bom.csv`).

BOM	Component	Role
1	Bottom panels, 6 mm okoume plywood (aft, forward flat, bow rake), 1,060 mm wide at the chine	Flat bottom with a knuckle and bow rake; glass outside only
2	Side panels, 4 mm okoume plywood (4)	Flat sides flared 8 deg; full length of each half
3, 4	Stern transom (9 mm) and bow transom (9 mm)	Close the ends; the stern transom carries the step and grab handles
5	Joint bulkheads, 6 mm plywood (2)	Close each half at the joint so each half floats alone
6	Ring frames, softwood 20 x 45 (3)	Stiffen the transom and the bulkheads and take the joint bolts
7	Inwales, softwood 20 x 40 (4)	Stiffen the sheer; hold handles, strakes and the bench modules
8	Stringers (6) and knuckle floor	Stiffen the floor; take the skid screws; join the bottom at the knuckle
9	Bench modules and bow box	Foam in sewn tarpaulin covers, strapped to bench rails; bow box wall and deck
10	Buoyancy foam, closed-cell polyethylene	0.56 m3 in the benches and bow box plus the step float core (LevelHull layout)
29	Stern quarter foam modules (2 x 15 L)	Keep the transom up when swamped; 250 mm clear between them for boarding
11	Joint bolts M10 x 80 with nut plates (8), alignment pins (2)	Join the halves with one spanner
12, 13	Rub strakes and bottom skids, HDPE	Protect the hull from walls, kerbs and debris
14	Stern step: hinge rail, backing block, float, strap hinges	Boarding platform on the water behind the transom
15, 16	Stop straps and pad eyes; kick rung on straps	Hold the step at 20 deg below level; first foothold below the float
17, 18	Transom grab handles (2) and carry handles (8)	Handholds for boarding; carrying each half or the whole boat
19, 20, 21	Push pole (two 1.5 m sections), paddles (2), bow eye and 10 m bow line	Propulsion and control in lanes; towing and holding at a doorway
22 to 28	Epoxy, glass, consumables, topcoat, screws, shoulder slings	Build materials and carrying slings

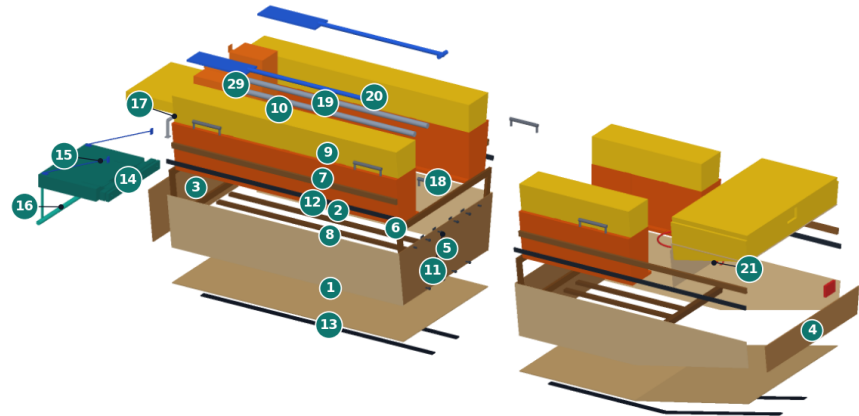
The optional fixed, forward-only fin drive is not part of the first prototype design; whether and how to add it is an open decision for Amish (LSK-DEC-001). The material substitution table is in the first-order numbers below.

LaneSkiff: exploded view

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/laneskiff

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION

- 1 Bottom panels
- 2 Side panels
- 3 Stern transom
- 4 Bow transom
- 5 Joint bulkheads
- 6 Ring frames
- 7 Inwales
- 8 Stringers and knuckle floor
- 9 Bench modules: rails, covers, straps and Bow box wall and deck
- 10 Buoyancy foam
- 11 Joint bolts and nut plates
- 12 Rub strakes
- 13 Bottom skids
- 14 Stern step
- 15 Stop straps and pad eyes
- 16 Kick rung
- 17 Transom grab handles
- 18 Carry handles
- 19 Push pole (two sections)
- 20 Paddles
- 21 Bow eye and bow line
- 29 Stern quarter foam modules



Seen from the front right and above, 24 deg elevation; halves pulled apart along the boat, stern step pulled aft, fittings lifted; numbers match bom/bom.csv

Figure 2. Exploded view: halves pulled apart along the boat, stern step pulled aft, fittings lifted. Numbers match the BOM.

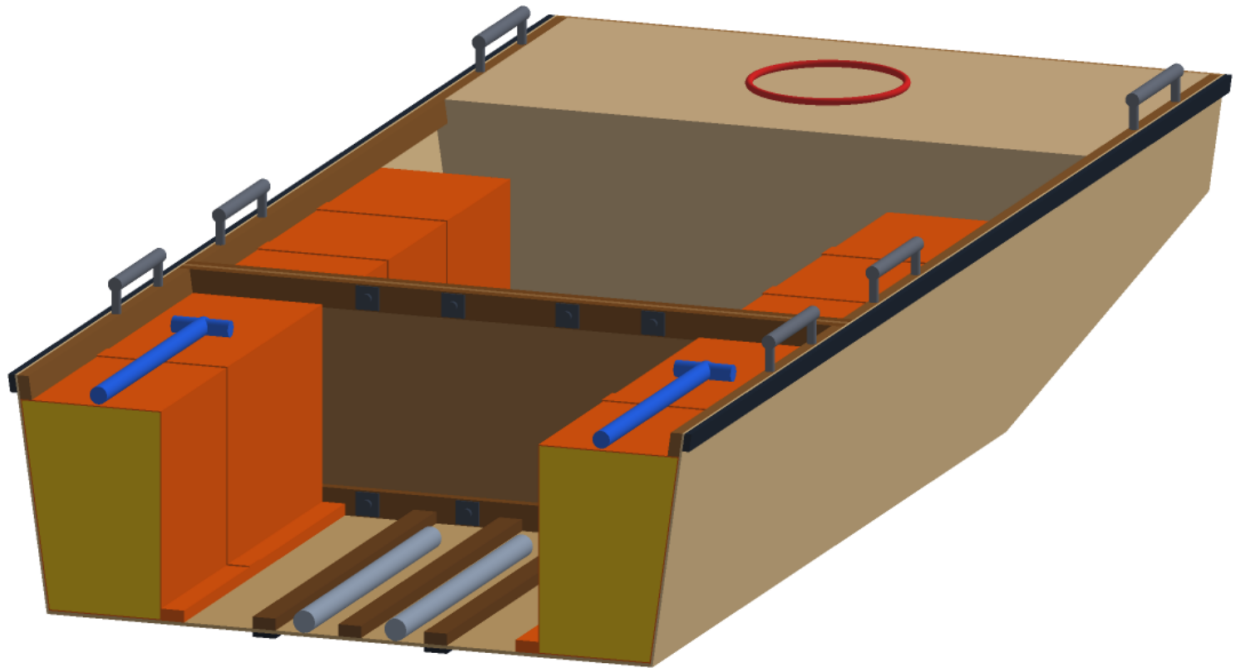
■ Key design choices

Decided under Amish's pre-approval of 2026-10-03 (LSK-DDR-001 and LSK-DDR-002):

- **Punt form, constant width.** A flat bottom 1.0 m wide at the chine for 2.7 m, raked to the bow, with flat flared sides: the widest waterline and lowest draft for a lane-width beam, from flat panels a local yard can cut.
- **Two closed halves.** Each half has its own bulkhead, so the joint needs no seal and a half that is holed or loose still floats. The halves are bolted, not hinged or folded (the Porta-Bote design-around).
- **Plywood and epoxy first.** Stitch-and-glue is the most widely known small-boat method in coastal India and Bangladesh; aluminium and HDPE sheet paths are documented at concept level.
- **LevelHull buoyancy layout.** Foam outboard along the sides and forward, never low on the floor; no lift is credited to the plywood or timber.
- **Stern-centre boarding.** A float on the water and a kick rung below it, with transom handholds, after the expired US6932020B2 boarding platform.
- **Conservative safety choices.** Persons count at two thirds of their weight when swamped; the float swing is checked for pinch points; the step is proof-loaded before any boarding trial.

LaneSkiff: cutaway across the aft halfgithub.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/laneskiff

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION



Cut across the boat 1.0 m forward of the transom, seen from aft and slightly to starboard, 14 deg elevation. The foam bench modules sit outboard against the sides, under the inwales, so a swamped boat floats level; the floor between them is clear for people. The two stern quarter modules stand either side of the step opening, aft of the cut

Figure 3. Cutaway across the aft half: the foam bench modules sit against the sides under the inwales; the floor between them is clear.

■ First-order numbers

From LSK-CAL-001 (docs/04-calcs/01-sizing.md); assumptions are stated there.

Table 2. First-order numbers, plywood and epoxy path, light timber specification.

Quantity	Value
Length, beam over strakes, depth	3.60 m, 1.197 m, 0.40 m
Hull mass as carried (pole, paddles and line not counted)	87.9 kg; aft half 49.9 kg, forward half 38.1 kg
Rated load	Five persons, 375 kg (4.3 times hull mass)
Draft at rated load	143 mm even keel; 148 mm at the transom, 138 mm at the forward end of the waterline
Draft with a crew of two	79 mm
Heel boarding over the stern step; over the side	3.3 deg; 12.8 deg
Swamped with rated persons	Afloat, trim 0.4 deg stern down, freeboard 161 mm at the transom and 188 mm at the bow; 216 mm at the transom with the aft-crew rule
Joining the halves	About 6 min, one 17 mm spanner (estimate)
Estimated cost of the constructable design	Value-engineering target: USD 1,500. Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 1,961 (USD 461 over the target)

Table 3. Material substitution table (hull mass and load carried at 150 mm draft, same hull form).

Build path	Hull mass	Load at 150 mm draft	Load over hull mass
Okoume plywood and epoxy, softwood framing (prototype)	88 kg	401 kg	4.6
Aluminium 5052 sheet, 2.0 to 2.5 mm, welded or riveted	101 kg	388 kg	3.8
HDPE or polypropylene sheet, 5 to 8 mm, plastic welded	111 kg	377 kg	3.4

The aluminium and plastic rows are screening estimates from panel areas; the framing, foam and fittings are the same as the plywood boat.

■ Patent design-arounds

From the preliminary patent, trademark and prior-art screen (not legal advice):

- Single flat hull, poled or paddled; no twin pontoons with a jet ski transom and hinged ramp (US7832348B2, Newcomb, to 2028-10-24).
- Two rigid halves that bolt together; no flexible panel hull with a folding transom (US9061734B2, Porta-Bote, to 2029-12-30).
- No fin drive in the first prototype (Amish, decision 32A). A fin drive, if ever added, fixed and forward-only, following the expired US6022249 form; no rotating or 360 degree drive (US10259553B2 MirageDrive 360, to 2037-08-22).
- No reverse mechanism in any fin drive (Hobie US9359052 and US9981726, status unverified); never use MirageDrive or Hobie marks.

- Builds on lapsed prior art: US6932020B2 and US7011036B1 boarding platforms; EP0631552B1 and US7854211B2 nesting hulls.

■ Shared blocks

- LevelHull (level-when-swamped buoyancy layout): foam modules outboard and high, in sewn covers.
- CalRig proof-load: the step hinge, stop straps, carry handles and bow eye are proof-loaded before trials.

■ Safety

Safety: LaneSkiff is published as an open engineering reference, not a certified rescue boat. Rescue in floodwater is hazardous: people can be swept off their feet, trapped under debris, cut, shocked by live wires or made ill by contaminated water.

- Crew and passengers wear life jackets at all times; crews need water rescue training under their own agency's rules.
- Not for swiftwater, surf, open water or water flowing faster than a person can wade against.
- Do not exceed the rated load: five persons for the first prototype (Amish, decision 30A), marked on the transom; the payload differs between build paths.
- Watch for submerged hazards, open drains, live electrical wires and contaminated water.
- The boarding step has a hinge and a swinging float: the 40 mm gap keeps fingers and feet clear through its 20 degree swing, and nobody holds the hinge edge while the step is folded or unfolded.
- When swamped, the aft crew member moves amidships and everyone stays seated, low and centred (LSK-CAL-001, section 4).
- The step, stop straps, handles and bow eye are proof-loaded to twice their working load before any boarding trial, and the first swamp test is run in calm, shallow water with a safety boat (LSK-BLD-001, safety stops).

■ Open questions

Open decisions and items to confirm are kept in the design decisions register, `docs/06-design-decisions.md` (LSK-DEC-001).